INTRODUCTION:

THE AMERICAN DREAM

It was 1940, and America was a nation divided. While what would become known as the Second World War raged overseas, the United States stood on the sidelines, its people debating the merits of joining a battle so far removed from their homeland. But in the heart of New York City, comic-book publisher Martin Goodman had no such reservations. Perhaps it was his Jewish heritage that caused him to take offense to Adolf Hitler's twisted Nazi agenda, or simply his need to comment on an unjust situation. Whatever his inspiration, Goodman couldn't just sit by quietly while his country did nothing.

So Martin Goodman declared war.

A full year before the devastating attack on Pearl Harbor that roused the United States into action, Goodman sent one of his most prized troops into battle: Namor, the rebellious Sub-Mariner. Fighting Nazis on the high-profile cover to *Marvel Mystery Comics #4,* the Sub-Mariner blatantly displayed Timely Comics' stance to the country's youth. And that was just the first shot fired.

Cover to *Captain America Comics #1* (1941) by Joe Simon and Jack Kirby, repainted by Kai Spannuth for *Captain America Comics #1: 70th Anniversary Edition* (2011).